



Arms at the National Museum

The National Museum at New Delhi has an impressive collection. Here is a shield made out of Rhino hide. <https://digit.in/Aug18-94-1>



Indian Mutiny Arms

The Canning Indian Mutiny Collection consists of pistols, muskets and swords used during the 1857 uprising. <https://digit.in/Aug18-94-2>



Indian Melee Weapons

Afzal Khan tried to kill Chatrapati Shivaji with a katar, but Shivaji defeated him with the dextrous use of a bagh nakh and a bichua. Want to know what these pre modern combat weapons are? Read on!

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KATAR

The Katar, Kitar or Katyar is a hand dagger that comes in many variants. There could be anywhere between one and three blades, and some had hoods to protect the fist. This specimen in The Royal Collection of the United Kingdom, has twin pistols on either side, to pack in some additional punch.

URUMI

The urumi or the chuttuval shown to the right is a long, ribbon like flexible metal sword. There are single blade and multi bladed variants, and the weapon can be dual wielded. If sloppily used, the weapon can easily hurt the person wielding it. Handling the weapon requires mastery of both a whip and a sword.



GADA

The gada or the mace was traditionally made using wood or iron. There was usually a spike on top of the spherical head. Variants had spikes or flanges. Some variants had a sword like hilt, and a full length blade mounted on top of the head. Wielding it is taught in a martial art known as gada-yuddha. Wrestlers still use it as part of their training regimen.



KHANDA

The Khanda is a double edged broadsword, is the oldest sword in India, and is present in the most ancient scriptures and art. The design of the sword is said to be improved by Prithviraj Chauhan. The sword was venerated by the Rajputs, and used in central India and Orissa as well.



TRISHUL

The trishul is a polearm, and is known as a trident. The original sanskrit word translates to "three thorns". In ancient times, it served the practical purpose of fishing, which is why in many civilisations around the world, including India, it is considered as a symbol of mastery over the waters.